SELLING AND NEGOTIATION · 6 MIN READ

Handling different customers, and difficult moments

The same bike is sold differently to different people. Read the customer first, then choose how to talk.

Five customers you will meet

CUSTOMER	HOW YOU KNOW	WHAT WORKS
The researcher	Quotes specs and reviews, has a shortlist	Respect the homework. Do not repeat the brochure. Add what the internet cannot: fit, a test ride, how the bike holds up in our workshop.
The beginner	Unsure of terms, asks "which is good?"	Simple words, no jargon. Ask about use, narrow to two bikes, explain one difference.
The price shopper	Opens with "best price?" or shows an online price	Do not start with a number. Find the need first, then show what our price includes: assembly, fit, free services, warranty support here in Pune.
The parent	Buying for a child	Safety and fit first. Size the child, not the age on the label. Do not sell a bike to "grow into".
The returning rider	Already owns a bike, wants an upgrade	Ask what the current bike does not do. Sell the difference, not the whole bike.

On the phone and WhatsApp

- Answer with the store name and your name.
- Reply to WhatsApp within minutes during working hours. A slow reply is where most inquiries go quiet.
- Do not send a price alone. Send the price with one line of what it includes and a question that moves things forward: "Would you like to try the size on Saturday?"

When a customer is angry

Use four steps, in this order.

- **Listen.** Let them finish. Do not interrupt or defend.
- **Acknowledge.** "I understand, you were told Friday and it is not ready. I am sorry about that."
- **Confirm.** Repeat the problem back so they know you have it right.
- **Own the next step.** Say what you will do and by when. Then do it, and call them before they call you.

Do not argue, do not blame a colleague or a vendor in front of the customer, and do not promise what you cannot deliver. If the fix needs money back, a replacement or an exception to policy, tell the customer you are taking it to the owners today, and do so.

Small things that customers remember

- Use their name.
- Remember what they ride. It is in the CRM notes.
- Call when you said you would, even if the answer is "no update yet".

Remember these

- Read the customer first: researcher, beginner, price shopper, parent, returning rider.
- Never open with a price. Find the need, then show what the price includes.
- Angry customer: listen, acknowledge, confirm, own the next step.
- Call when you said you would, even with no update.